

All about me

- **BORN:** 1254
- **DIED:** 1324
- **NATIONALITY:** Italian
- **FACTOID:** I traveled more than 14,900 miles (4,000 km).
- **IN A NUTSHELL:** My father and uncle traveled to China to trade jewels and met the Mongol ruler.

By the way...

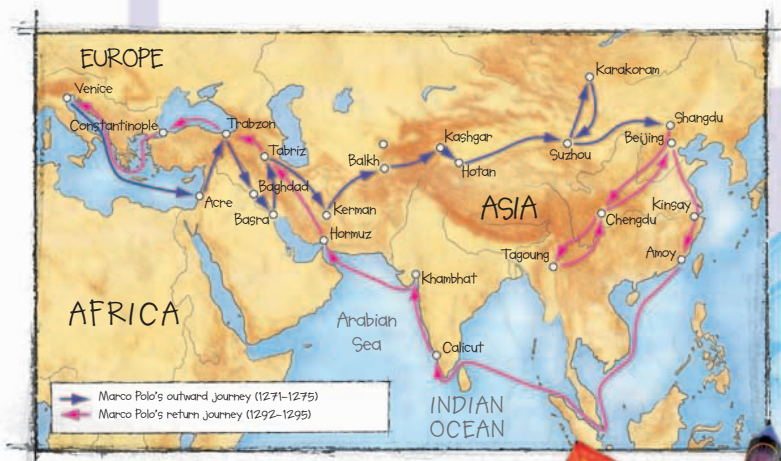
my book gave Europe its first look into Asia, but many people didn't believe me and said I'd made it up.

Marco Polo

The man whose journey of a lifetime brought the FAR EAST to Europe

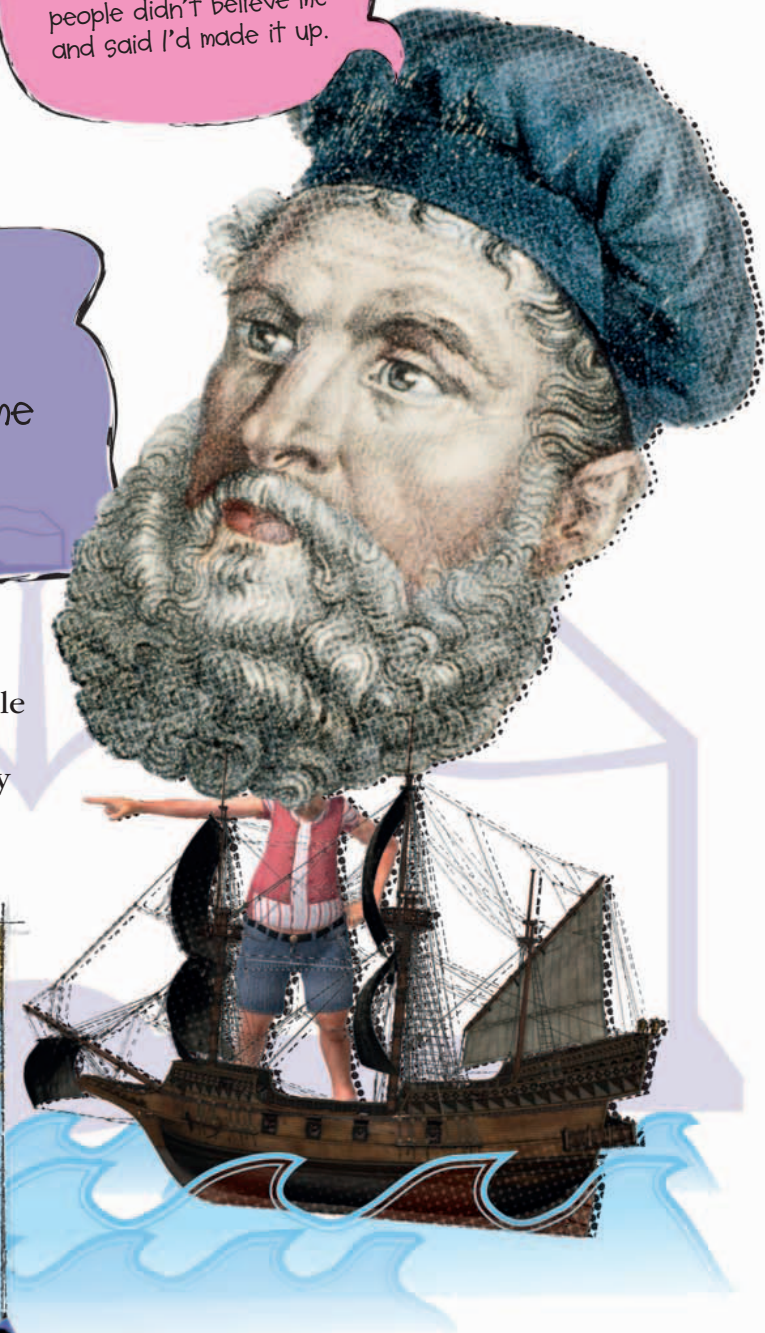
Marco sets off

When Marco was 17, he accompanied his father and uncle when they **returned to China** (see purple line on map). They spent 17 years in the court of the Mongol ruler of China, **Kublai Khan**. He really liked Marco, first making him a diplomat and then the **GOVERNOR** of the city of Yangzhou.



Marco brought the first kite to Europe from China.

He also introduced Europe to the power of gunpowder.



Return to Venice

Khan liked Marco so much that even though the Polos asked to return home, he **refused to let them leave**. Luckily, in 1292, the Polos were sent to escort a Mongol princess to Persia (modern-day Iran). They seized the opportunity, **ESCAPED**, and returned home after 24 years (see pink line on map). Marco wrote a book about his adventures, ***The Travels of Marco Polo***.